

ZIRUI ZHAO

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EDUCATION	National University of Singapore, Singapore Ph.D. in Computer Science, advisor: Dr. Wee Sun Lee, Dr. David Hsu	2020 - 2025
	Xi'an Jiaotong University, Xi'an, China B.Eng. in Automation, advisor: Dr. Pengju Ren	2016 - 2020
EMPLOYMENT	Salesforce.com, Singapore • Research Scientist, Salesforce AI Research • PhD Research Intern, Salesforce AI Research	2025 - Now Summer 2024
	National University of Singapore, Singapore • Full-time Teaching Assistant, Dept. of Computer Science • Full-time Research Assistant, Dept. of Computer Science	2024 - 2025 2024
	Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA, USA • Undergraduate Research Intern, Safe AI Lab	Summer 2019
	AWARDS	
	• Student Tutor Honour List	School of Computing, NUS, 2024
	• Research Achievement Award	School of Computing, NUS, 2024
	• Teaching Fellowship Nomination	School of Computing, NUS, 2024
	• Best Paper Runner-up	LTAMP workshop @ Robotics: Science & Systems, 2023
	• NUS Research Scholarship	National University of Singapore, 2020 - 2024
	• Excellant Graduate	Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2020
	• Dean's List	Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2017 & 2018 & 2019
	• 2nd price – 1989 Mechanical Alumni Scholarship	Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2018
	• Siyuan Merit Scholarship	Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2017
RESEARCH	(*Equal contribution, listed in alphabetical order)	
	[1] Y. Bu, X. Wu, Z. Zhao , Y. Cai, D. Hsu, and Q. Liu. "Walk in Others' Shoes with a Single Glance: Human-Centric Visual Grounding with Top-View Perspective Transformation". In: <i>The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)</i> . 2025.	
	[2] Z. Zhao , H. Dong, A. Saha, C. Xiong, and D. Sahoo. "Automatic Curriculum Expert Iteration for Reliable LLM Reasoning". In: <i>The Thirteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)</i> . 2025.	
	[3] L. Kang*, Z. Zhao* , D. Hsu, and W. S. Lee. "On the Empirical Complexity of Reasoning and Planning in LLMs". In: <i>Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP</i> . 2024.	
	[4] Z. Zhao , W. S. Lee, and D. Hsu. "Large Language Models as Commonsense Knowledge for Large-Scale Task Planning". In: <i>Thirty-seventh Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)</i> . 2023.	
	[5] Z. Zhao , W. S. Lee, and D. Hsu. "Differentiable Parsing and Visual Grounding of Natural Language Instructions for Object Placement". In: <i>2023 IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)</i> . 2023.	
	[6] R. Chen, W. Wang, Z. Zhao , and D. Zhao. "Active learning for risk-sensitive inverse reinforcement learning". In: <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:1909.07843</i> (2019).	
	[7] Z. Zhao , Y. Mao, Y. Ding, P. Ren, and N. Zheng. "Visual-based semantic SLAM with landmarks for large-scale outdoor environment". In: <i>2019 2nd China Symposium on Cognitive Computing and Hybrid Intelligence (CCHI)</i> . IEEE. 2019.	

TEACHING

CS1010S Programming Methodology (NUS)

Fall 2024, Spring 2025

- Foundation course for basic programming. Taught recitation classes.

CS3263 Foundations of AI (NUS)

Spring 2023, Fall 2023

- Introductory AI course for 2nd or 3rd year undergrads. Taught tutorial classes.